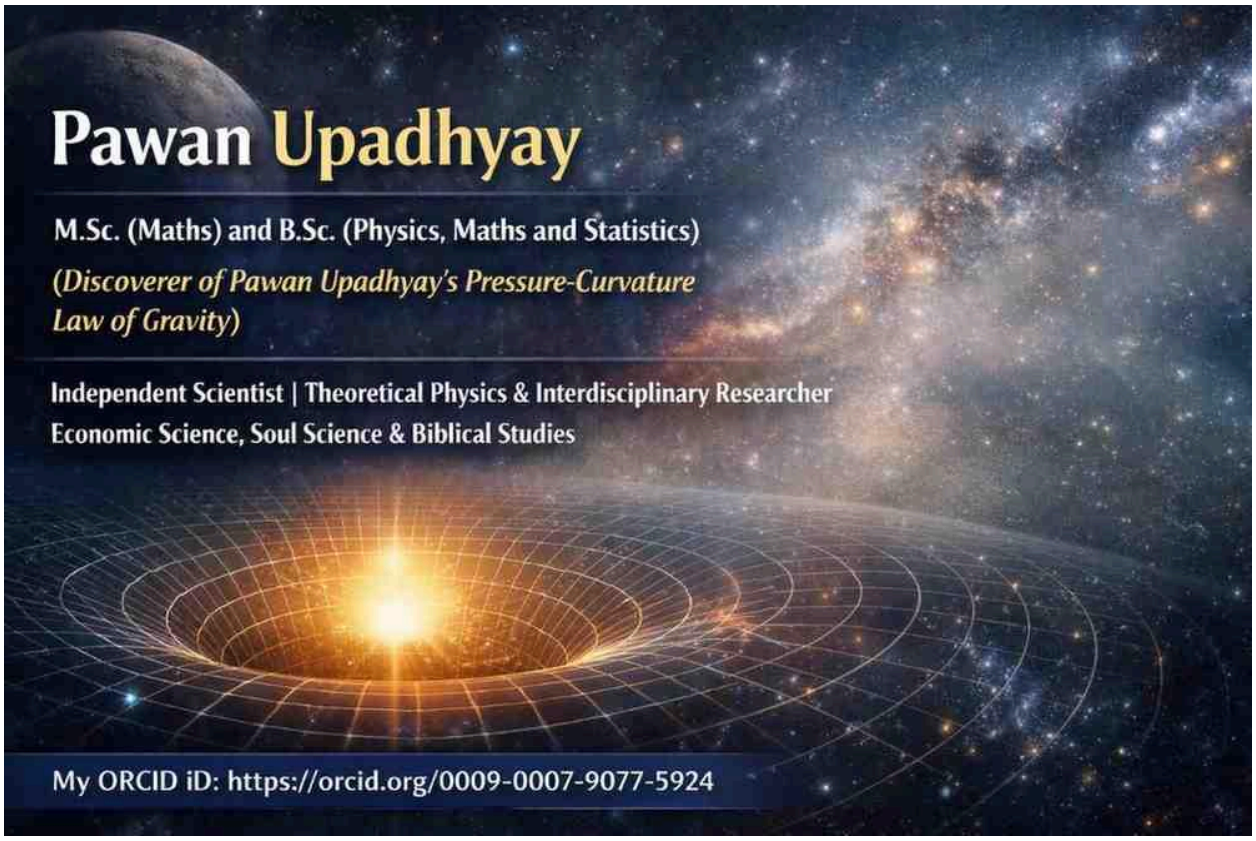
A Mathematical Analysis of the de Broglie Wavelength in the Context of Wavelength Density, Momentum Density, and Mass Density

Author: Pawan Upadhyay
Affiliation: Independent Researcher and Independent Scientist
Email:pawanupadhyay28@hotmail.com
2nd Email: pawankanyakubj@gmail.com
ORCID iD: https://orcid.org/0009-0007-9077-5924



Abstract

The de Broglie relation establishes a connection between the wavelength associated with a particle and its momentum. This research paper examines that relationship using three quantities: wavelength density (λ_d), momentum density (p_d), and mass density (ρ). Starting

from the established de Broglie equation, $\lambda = h/p$, and the definitions $\lambda_d = \lambda/V$ and $p_d = p/V$, the paper derives mathematical relationships connecting these quantities.

For a body of mass m moving with velocity v, the nonrelativistic momentum is $p = mv$. When mass density is defined as $\rho = m/V$, momentum density becomes $p_d = \rho v$. Substituting the momentum-density definition into the de Broglie relation gives $\lambda = h/(p_d V)$, and the wavelength-density definition then gives $\lambda_d = h/(p_d V^2)$.

These derived expressions are algebraic consequences of the original equations and definitions. They do not establish a new physical law by themselves. The paper discusses dimensional consistency, the interpretation of reference volume, limitations, and possible directions for experimental investigation.

Keywords: de Broglie wavelength, wavelength density, momentum density, mass density, Planck's constant, matter waves, dimensional analysis.

1. Introduction

In 1924, Louis de Broglie proposed that particles of matter possess wave-like properties. His hypothesis established a relationship between a particle's momentum and its associated wavelength. The de Broglie relation is now an established part of quantum physics and is supported by experimental observations such as electron diffraction.

The standard de Broglie equation is:

$\lambda = h/p$

For a particle moving at a speed much smaller than the speed of light, momentum can be approximated as:

$p = mv$

Therefore:

$\lambda = h/(mv)$

The more general expression $\lambda = h/p$ applies when p represents the particle's appropriate momentum, including relativistic momentum where necessary.

This paper extends the mathematical discussion by considering wavelength density, momentum density, and mass density. The purpose is to investigate the relationships that follow when these quantities are defined per unit volume.

2. Objectives of the Research

The objectives are:

1. To explain the established de Broglie wavelength relation.
2. To define wavelength density as $\lambda_d = \lambda/V$.
3. To define momentum density as $p_d = p/V$.
4. To derive momentum density in terms of mass density and velocity.
5. To express the de Broglie relation using λ_d, p_d, and ρ.
6. To verify the dimensions and SI units of the derived expressions.
7. To distinguish mathematical derivations from independently established physical laws.

3. Established de Broglie Equation

The de Broglie relation is:

$$\lambda = h/p$$

Where:

λ = de Broglie wavelength, measured in metres (m).

h = Planck's constant, approximately $6.62607015 \times 10^{-34}$ J·s.

p = magnitude of the particle's momentum, measured in kg·m/s.

For a nonrelativistic particle:

$$p = mv$$

Where:

m = particle mass in kilograms (kg).

v = particle velocity in metres per second (m/s).

Substituting $p = mv$ into the de Broglie relation gives:

$$\lambda = h/(mv)$$

This form is applicable when the nonrelativistic momentum approximation is valid.

4. Definition of Wavelength Density

In this research framework, wavelength density is defined as wavelength divided by a specified reference volume.

$$\lambda_d = \lambda/V$$

Where:

λ_d = wavelength density.

λ = wavelength.

V = reference volume in cubic metres (m^3).

Since wavelength has the SI unit m and volume has the SI unit m^3, the unit of wavelength density is:

Unit of $\lambda_d = m/m^3 = m^{-2}$

Therefore, wavelength density has the SI unit of inverse square metres.

This is a volume-normalized mathematical quantity. Its value depends on the wavelength and the chosen reference volume. It should not automatically be interpreted as a conventional physical density or as the number of wavelengths physically contained in a volume.

5. Definition of Momentum Density

Momentum density is defined here as momentum per unit reference volume:

$p_d = p/V$

Where:

p_d = momentum density.

p = total linear momentum.

V = reference volume.

The SI unit of momentum is kg·m/s. Dividing by volume gives:

Unit of $p_d = (kg \cdot m/s)/m^3$

Therefore:

Unit of $p_d = kg/(m^2 \cdot s)$

For a body whose momentum is $p = mv$:

$p_d = mv/V$

Rearranging:

$p_d = (m/V)v$

This leads to the relationship with mass density.

6. Relationship Between Momentum Density and Mass Density

Mass density is defined as mass per unit volume:

$\rho = m/V$

Where:

ρ = mass density, measured in kg/m^3.

Substituting $\rho = m/V$ into the momentum-density expression gives:

$p_d = \rho v$

This is the central relationship between momentum density, mass density, and velocity in the present framework.

The SI units confirm dimensional consistency:

ρ has units kg/m^3.

v has units m/s.

Therefore:

$\rho v = (kg/m^3)(m/s) = kg/(m^2 \cdot s)$

This matches the SI unit of p_d.

For a uniform body moving with a common velocity, $p_d = \rho v$ represents its momentum per unit volume. In a continuous medium with spatially varying density and velocity, the corresponding local momentum-density field is expressed as ρv.

7. Derivation of the de Broglie Relation Using Momentum Density

Begin with the established de Broglie relation:

$\lambda = h/p$

From the definition of momentum density:

$p_d = p/V$

Rearranging gives:

$p = p_d V$

Substitute this expression for p into the de Broglie equation:

$\lambda = h/(p_d V)$

This is the de Broglie relation expressed in terms of momentum density and reference volume.

The expression follows directly from the original de Broglie relation and the definition $p_d = p/V$. It does not introduce a new independent physical law.

8. Derivation of Wavelength Density Using Momentum Density

The wavelength-density definition is:

$\lambda_d = \lambda/V$

From the preceding section:

$\lambda = h/(p_d V)$

Substituting into $\lambda_d = \lambda/V$ gives:

$\lambda_d = [h/(p_d V)]/V$

Simplifying:

$\lambda_d = h/(p_d V^2)$

Therefore, the derived expression is:

$\lambda_d = h/(p_d V^2)$

This equation connects wavelength density with Planck's constant, momentum density, and reference volume under the definitions used in this paper.

The equation is an algebraic consequence of $\lambda = h/p$, $\lambda_d = \lambda/V$, and $p_d = p/V$. Its validity as an identity depends on using the same nonzero reference volume V consistently.

9. Derivation Using Mass Density and Velocity

The momentum-density relationship is:

$p_d = \rho v$

Substituting $p_d = \rho v$ into the de Broglie relation expressed in terms of momentum density gives:

$\lambda = h/(\rho v V)$

Dividing both sides by V, according to the definition $\lambda_d = \lambda/V$, gives:

$\lambda_d = h/(\rho v V^2)$

Thus, the framework produces the following expressions:

De Broglie wavelength:

$\lambda = h/(\rho v V)$

Wavelength density:

$\lambda_d = h/(\rho v V^2)$

These forms assume that the total momentum can be represented as $p = \rho v V$. This is appropriate for a uniform body or a volume with uniform density and velocity, using $\rho = m/V$. For a nonuniform medium, total momentum generally requires integrating the local momentum density throughout the region.

10. Summary of the Mathematical Relationships

The main equations derived in this paper are:

1. de Broglie relation: $\lambda = h/p$
2. Nonrelativistic momentum: $p = mv$
3. Wavelength density: $\lambda_d = \lambda/V$
4. Momentum density: $p_d = p/V$
5. Mass density: $\rho = m/V$
6. Momentum density in terms of mass density: $p_d = \rho v$
7. de Broglie wavelength in terms of momentum density: $\lambda = h/(p_d V)$
8. Wavelength density in terms of momentum density: $\lambda_d = h/(p_d V^2)$
9. de Broglie wavelength in terms of mass density: $\lambda = h/(\rho v V)$
10. Wavelength density in terms of mass density: $\lambda_d = h/(\rho v V^2)$

The last four expressions follow algebraically from the first definitions and relations under the stated assumptions.

11. Dimensional Analysis

Dimensional analysis checks whether the units on the two sides of an equation agree.

11.1 Wavelength Density

$\lambda_d = \lambda/V$

The right-hand side has dimensions:

$m/m^3 = m^{-2}$

Therefore, λ_d has the correct unit m^{-2} under its definition.

11.2 Momentum Density

$p_d = p/V$

The right-hand side has dimensions:

$(kg \cdot m/s)/m^3 = kg/(m^2 \cdot s)$

Therefore, p_d has the unit $kg/(m^2 \cdot s)$.

11.3 Momentum Density and Mass Density

$p_d = \rho v$

The right-hand side has dimensions:

$(kg/m^3)(m/s) = kg/(m^2 \cdot s)$

This agrees with the dimensions of momentum density.

11.4 Wavelength Density From Momentum Density

$\lambda_d = h/(p_d V^2)$

Planck's constant h has dimensions $kg \cdot m^2/s$.

The denominator has dimensions:

$[kg/(m^2 \cdot s)] \times m^6 = kg \cdot m^4/s$

The quotient therefore has dimensions:

$(kg \cdot m^2/s)/(kg \cdot m^4/s) = m^{-2}$

This agrees with the defined unit of λ_d.

11.5 Wavelength Density From Mass Density

$\lambda_d = h/(\rho v V^2)$

The denominator has dimensions:

$(kg/m^3)(m/s)(m^6) = kg \cdot m^4/s$

The resulting unit is:

$(kg \cdot m^2/s)/(kg \cdot m^4/s) = m^{-2}$

This is dimensionally consistent.

Dimensional consistency is necessary for a valid physical equation, but it does not by itself prove that a newly defined quantity has independent physical significance.

12. Interpretation of the Reference Volume

An important point is that wavelength density and momentum density are defined relative to a specified volume.

For a fixed particle with fixed momentum p, changing the reference volume changes the calculated momentum density $p_d = p/V$. If wavelength λ remains fixed, the calculated wavelength density $\lambda_d = \lambda/V$ also changes.

These changes do not, by themselves, imply that the particle's momentum or de Broglie wavelength has physically changed. The volume-normalized quantities depend on how the reference region is chosen.

For this reason, comparisons of λ_d and p_d must state the reference volume and explain why that volume is physically relevant.

For an extended body or material medium, density per unit volume can have a direct continuum-mechanics interpretation. For a single particle, assigning its total momentum to a chosen volume is a mathematical normalization unless a specific physical model gives that volume a further meaning.

13. Physical Meaning and Limitations

The established de Broglie relation connects wavelength with momentum. It is foundational to quantum mechanics and is supported by experiments involving particle diffraction.

The quantities λ_d and p_d used here are introduced through definitions based on a reference volume. The derived equations are mathematically consistent when the definitions and assumptions are applied consistently.

However, the following limitations must be recognized:

1. Wavelength density as defined here is not automatically a standard intrinsic property of a particle.
2. Momentum density for a body or continuous medium has a clear interpretation as momentum per unit volume; for a single particle, its interpretation depends on the chosen reference volume.
3. The expression $p_d = \rho v$ assumes a suitable mass-density and velocity description, such as a uniform body or a local continuum description.
4. The equations do not establish that wavelength physically changes when the reference volume changes.
5. The derivations do not, by themselves, establish a new quantum-mechanical law or a new experimentally verified physical effect.

To establish additional physical significance, future research would need a clearly specified physical model, measurable predictions, and experiments that distinguish those predictions from the standard de Broglie relation.

14. Possible Directions for Further Research

Future work could examine whether volume-normalized quantities are useful in specific physical systems, including:

- Particle beams with defined beam volumes.
- Matter waves in confined systems.
- Quantum particles interacting with material boundaries.
- Uniform and nonuniform particle distributions.
- Comparisons between local momentum density and the wavelength associated with a particle's momentum.

Any such investigation should distinguish between changes caused by the choice of reference volume and changes caused by actual physical interactions or boundary conditions.

15. Conclusion

This paper has examined the de Broglie wavelength equation in the context of wavelength density (λ_d), momentum density (p_d), and mass density (ρ).

Starting from $\lambda = h/p$ and defining $p_d = p/V$, the paper derives $\lambda = h/(p_d V)$. Applying the wavelength-density definition $\lambda_d = \lambda/V$ gives $\lambda_d = h/(p_d V^2)$. Using the relationship $p_d = \rho v$ leads to $\lambda = h/(\rho v V)$ and $\lambda_d = h/(\rho v V^2)$, under the stated assumptions.

The derived expressions are dimensionally consistent and follow algebraically from the established de Broglie relation and the volume-normalization definitions. Their use does not automatically demonstrate a new physical law. The physical interpretation of the density quantities depends on the chosen reference volume and the system under investigation.

The central conclusion is that the de Broglie relation can be rewritten using λ_d, p_d, and ρ, while preserving the distinction between established quantum physics and additional mathematical definitions.

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Research Status

This paper presents a mathematical analysis of established relations using volume-normalized definitions of wavelength density and momentum density. The algebraic derivations and dimensional checks do not, by themselves, establish a new physical law. Further physical interpretation and experimental validation would be required to demonstrate any additional independent significance.

Separate Note: Compton Wavelength in the Context of λ_d, p_d, and ρ

1. Definition of Compton Wavelength

The Compton wavelength is a characteristic length associated with a particle of mass m. The standard Compton wavelength is defined as:

$\lambda_C = h/(mc)$

Where:

λ_C = Compton wavelength, measured in metres (m).

h = Planck's constant, approximately $6.62607015 \times 10^{-34}$ J·s.

m = particle's rest mass, measured in kilograms (kg).

c = speed of light in vacuum, approximately 299,792,458 m/s.

The Compton wavelength is distinct from the de Broglie wavelength. The de Broglie wavelength depends on a particle's momentum, while the standard Compton wavelength depends on its rest mass.

2. Compton Wavelength and Wavelength Density

In this research framework, wavelength density is defined as:

$\lambda_d = \lambda/V$

Applying this definition to the Compton wavelength gives a corresponding volume-normalized quantity:

$\lambda_{Cd} = \lambda_C/V$

Substituting the standard Compton wavelength equation:

$\lambda_{Cd} = h/(mcV)$

Here, λ_{Cd} represents the Compton wavelength divided by a specified reference volume. Its SI unit is m^{-2}.

This is a mathematical extension of the wavelength-density definition. It should not be confused with a separate, conventionally established intrinsic property called Compton wavelength density.

3. Relationship with Momentum Density and Mass Density

Momentum density is defined as:

$p_d = p/V$

For a uniform body or a volume with uniform mass density and velocity:

$p_d = \rho v$

Where:

p_d = momentum density, measured in kg/(m²·s).

ρ = mass density, measured in kg/m³.

v = velocity, measured in m/s.

For a particle, the de Broglie wavelength can be written as:

$$\lambda = h/p$$

Using $p = p_d V$ gives:

$$\lambda = h/(p_d V)$$

The corresponding wavelength density is:

$$\lambda_d = h/(p_d V^2)$$

However, these equations describe the de Broglie wavelength and its volume-normalized form. They should not be substituted directly for the Compton wavelength formula, because the two wavelengths have different definitions and physical meanings.

The Compton wavelength is determined by the particle's rest mass:

$$\lambda_C = h/(mc)$$

If the mass density is defined as $\rho = m/V$ for a specified body or region, then $m = \rho V$, and the Compton wavelength can be rewritten as:

$$\lambda_C = h/(\rho V c)$$

Dividing by the reference volume gives:

$$\lambda_{Cd} = h/(\rho V^2 c)$$

This final expression follows algebraically when $\rho = m/V$ uses the same reference volume V. It does not mean that the particle's intrinsic Compton wavelength changes when an arbitrary reference volume is changed.

4. Physical Interpretation

The standard Compton wavelength is an established physical quantity associated with a particle's rest mass. For an electron, its approximate value is 2.426×10^{-12} m.

The volume-normalized expression $\lambda_{Cd} = \lambda_C/V$ depends on the chosen reference volume. Changing that volume changes the calculated value of λ_{Cd}, but does not, by itself, change the particle's rest mass or its standard Compton wavelength.

Similarly, ρ is mass per unit volume, whereas p_d is momentum per unit volume. These quantities describe different physical properties and should not be treated as interchangeable.

5. Conclusion

The standard Compton wavelength is defined by $\lambda_C = h/(mc)$. Applying the research framework's volume-normalization definition produces $\lambda_{Cd} = \lambda_C/V = h/(mcV)$.

For a region in which $\rho = m/V$, the same expression can be written as $\lambda_{Cd} = h/(\rho V^2 c)$. These are algebraically equivalent expressions under the stated definitions.

The distinction between intrinsic particle properties and quantities normalized by an arbitrary reference volume must remain clear. The volume-normalized expression is a mathematical definition, not an independently established new physical law.

Separate Note: Comparison of Compton Wavelengths of the Electron, Proton, and Neutron in the Context of λ_{Cd}

The Compton wavelength is a characteristic length associated with a particle's rest mass. The standard Compton wavelength is defined as:

$\lambda_C = h/(mc)$

Where:

λ_C = standard Compton wavelength, measured in metres (m).

h = Planck's constant.

m = particle's rest mass.

c = speed of light in vacuum.

The standard Compton wavelengths of the electron, proton, and neutron are approximately:

1. Electron: $\lambda_C \approx 2.42631 \times 10^{-12}$ m.
2. Proton: $\lambda_C \approx 1.32141 \times 10^{-15}$ m.

3. Neutron: $\lambda_C \approx 1.31959 \times 10^{-15}$ m.

These values demonstrate that the electron's Compton wavelength is much greater than those of the proton and neutron because the electron has a much smaller rest mass. The proton's Compton wavelength is slightly greater than the neutron's because the proton's rest mass is slightly smaller.

Compton Wavelength Density

In the present research framework, a volume-normalized Compton wavelength can be defined as:

$\lambda_{Cd} = \lambda_C/V$

Substituting the standard Compton wavelength equation gives:

$\lambda_{Cd} = h/(mcV)$

Here, λ_{Cd} is a volume-normalized mathematical quantity with the SI unit m^{-2}. Its value depends on the reference volume V selected for the calculation.

For an illustrative reference volume of $V = 1\ m^3$, the numerical values are:

- Electron: $\lambda_{Cd} \approx 2.42631 \times 10^{-12}\ m^{-2}$.
- Proton: $\lambda_{Cd} \approx 1.32141 \times 10^{-15}\ m^{-2}$.
- Neutron: $\lambda_{Cd} \approx 1.31959 \times 10^{-15}\ m^{-2}$.

The numerical values match the corresponding Compton wavelengths because the reference volume is $1\ m^3$; however, the units differ.

Relationship with Mass Density

Mass density is defined as:

$\rho = m/V$

If ρ represents the mass of a specified body or region divided by the same reference volume V, then $m = \rho V$. Substituting this relationship into the Compton wavelength equation gives:

$\lambda_C = h/(\rho V c)$

Applying the volume-normalized definition gives:

$\lambda_{Cd} = h/(\rho V^2 c)$

This expression is an algebraic consequence of the stated definitions when the same reference volume is used consistently. For an individual elementary particle, the standard Compton wavelength is determined by its rest mass, not by an arbitrarily chosen reference volume. Therefore, the volume-normalized quantity λ_Cd should not be interpreted as an intrinsic particle property without a further physical model.

Conclusion

The electron, proton, and neutron have different standard Compton wavelengths because their rest masses differ. The electron has the largest Compton wavelength among these three particles, while the proton's Compton wavelength is slightly greater than the neutron's.

The definition λ_Cd = λ_C/V provides a mathematical way to normalize Compton wavelength by a reference volume. Its value depends on the chosen volume, whereas the standard Compton wavelength remains determined by the particle's rest mass. This volume-normalized definition does not, by itself, establish a new physical law or demonstrate that the intrinsic physical properties of these particles change with the reference volume.